



Art – Grade 1

OPTIMA ACADEMY ONLINE · FAMILY COURSE OVERVIEW · GRADE 1 · FULL YEAR

80 min per week · 2 lessons weekly

About this overview. This document is an example of how the course might be taught. This page is drawn from the Florida course description rather than a built Optima course, so the specific artworks studied, projects, and activities will be set by the teacher and may vary between the live school and On-Demand. Each teacher also leans into their own strengths and passions; the structure, expectations, and time commitment below are representative of the course as designed.

Grade 1 art moves from exploring to experimenting. Scholars try a variety of concepts and ideas across art and digital media, using materials correctly and safely to make art about what interests them most. They begin using the elements of art and principles of design on purpose, create imagery and personal symbols to express thoughts and feelings, and tell personal stories through their work. Accurate art vocabulary grows all year, so scholars can describe their steps, interpret artworks with clues, and talk about what makes craftsmanship good.

THE YEAR AT A GLANCE

1 Making Art (all year)

Experimenting with processes and media in two and three dimensions; correct, safe tool use; the steps of art production.

3 Talking About Art (all year)

Gathering clues to interpret artworks, describing visual imagery, and discussing good craftsmanship with accurate vocabulary.

5 Art in My World (all year)

Personal symbols that document community, art's everyday uses, artists' impact on designed objects, and connections to other subjects.

2 The Artist's Eye (all year)

Identifying and using the elements of art and principles of design; creating imagery and symbols that express thoughts and feelings.

4 Art Across Cultures (all year)

Comparing artworks from different cultures and times to spot differences in style and media; how art communicates culture.

A TYPICAL WEEK

- Two short art lessons each week.
- Lessons pair looking and making: scholars study real artworks and ideas, then create with their own hands.
- Scholars tell personal stories through art and present their work with growing vocabulary.
- Hands-on throughout — this course is built around real art materials, used correctly and safely.

TIME COMMITMENT

80 minutes / week

two lessons a week, about 40 minutes each

- Most weeks pair two short lessons of looking, learning, and making.
- Some projects span more than one lesson.

WHAT SCHOLARS NEED

- Basic art supplies: crayons, pencils, paper, child-safe scissors, and glue, plus materials as assigned.
- A computer with reliable internet and access to Canvas (with a grown-up's help).
- A space where making — and a little mess — is okay.

On-Demand (asynchronous). Scholars move through the course at their own pace, with due dates to keep the year on track. An Optima teacher is available throughout for support, feedback, and grading.

Live school. Live-school scholars take this same course on Optima's VR campus with a teacher and classmates, meeting twice a week as a specials class on the school's weekly schedule.